INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CUP, PAPER, (MEDICINE)

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Washington, D. C., 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Type and size. Paper medicine cups covered by this specification shall be of one type and size as hereinafter specified.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATION AND STANDARD

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specification:

PPP-B-636 - Box, fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C., 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Testing Methods:

T401 M - Fiber Identification and Quantitative Determination.

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T411M - Thickness and Density of Paper.

(Copies may be obtained from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 122 East 42nd Street, New York 17, New York.)

Federal Food and Drug Administration Publications:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies may be obtained upon application accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash, to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402. Price may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The cups shall be made from fully bleached paper or paper board containing no ground wood pulp, and shall be paraffin treated. Cups shall be free from disagreeable odor and shall not impart objectionable taste to the contents. Materials in the finished cups shall conform in all respects to the standards set forth in the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act as amended and regulations issued thereunder.

3.2 Construction

3.2.1 Cups. The construction of the cups as set forth in paragraph 3.2.2, shall be of two piece construction with plain unpleated side walls. The cups shall be round of the nested type, with reinforced or rolled top edges and flat recessed bottoms.

3.2.2 Capacity, weight, thickness. The cups shall conform to the requirements of Table I.

Table I - Cup Requirements

Minimum Capacity	Normal Capacity	Weight of 100 cups	Thickness Wall	Thickness Bottom
			Untreated Paper	
	Minimum Average	Minimum Average	Minimum Average	Minimum Average
Fluid oz.	Fluid oz.	Ounces	Inch	Inch
1	1-1/4	5	0.0055	0.0078

3.3 Marking. The side wall of each cup shall be marked with the following graduation measurements of the approximate contents:

1 oz.	30 ml.
3/4 oz.	25 ml.
1/2 oz.	20 ml.
1/4 oz.	15 ml.
	10 ml.
	5 ml.

In addition to the above graduations, each cup shall bear the words "MEDICINE - CUP" printed in letters not less than 1/16 inch high. (An imprinting of the physician or medical corp. symbol (caduceus) is acceptable.) Color of printing shall be the manufacturer's standard.

3.4 Leakage. When tested in accordance with 4.3.3, the cups shall show no evidence of leakage within 120 minutes from time of filling.

3.5 Rigidity. The cups shall have sufficient rigidity so that they will not collapse under normal filling and handling conditions or when tested in accordance with 4.3.4.

3.6 Workmanship. The cups shall be free from defects which adversely affect their appearance and serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and service conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 End product inspection. The inspection lot shall consist of all cups offered for inspection at the same time. The sample unit shall be one completely finished cup.

4.2.1.1 Visual examination. Examination of the end item shall be in accordance with the classification of defects in table II. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.1.2 Dimensional examination. Examination shall be made of the cups for defects in dimensions. Any dimension that is not within specified requirements shall be classified a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Table II - Classification of defects.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Material	Not fully bleached paper or paper board	X	
	Not paraffin treated	X	
	Disagreeable odor	X	
Construction	Not plain unpleated side walls	X	
	Not round	X	
	Not nestable	X	
	Rolled top edge missing	X	
	Not flat recessed bottom	X	
Marking	Graduation measurements missing or imperfect		X
	"MEDICINE-CUP" letters less than 1/16 inch high		X

4.2.1.3 End product testing. Cups shall be tested as specified in 4.3.1 through 4.3.6 inclusive. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units. Any nonconformance shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking as required by section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored as specified in table III. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Table III - Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.
Contents (exterior and interior container)	Number per container is more or less than required. Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 Normal Capacity. Normal capacity shall be determined by measuring the volume of water required to fill the cup to the brim.

4.3.2 Weight. The weight of 100 cups shall be calculated from the weight of 10 or more cups.

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4.3.3 Leakage. The cups shall be filled with water at room temperature and observed for leakage at the end of the time specified in 3.4. Not less than 50 cups shall be tested, and slight leakage of 1 out of each 50 cups tested will be permissible.

4.3.4 Rigidity. The rigidity shall be determined on the filled cups used for the leakage test, at the end of the time specified for the leakage test 4.3.3. The rigidity shall be observed while holding the cup in a normal, suspended drinking position.

4.3.5 Objectionable taste. Whether the cups impart an objectionable taste shall be determined by tasting the water in the cups at the end of the leakage test 4.3.3.

4.3.6 Other tests. The presence of ground wood pulp in the paper or paperboard from which the cups are fabricated shall be determined in accordance with TAPPI Test Method T401M. The paper thickness shall be determined in accordance with TAPPI Test Method T411-M (see 3.1 and 3.2.2).

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. One hundred (100) cups of like description shall be nested and packaged in a close-fitting paper tube or box. The tube or box shall be adequately secured.

5.1.2 Level B. The cups shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The cups shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Fifty (50) tubes or boxes of cups of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c. The box shall be closed, waterproofed sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Fifty (50) tubes or boxes of cups of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The cups shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination in containers at lowest rates complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Standard Packaging (Civil agencies). The standard packaging and packing for civil agencies shall be as specified in 5.1.2 and 5.2.2, respectively.

5.4 Marking.

5.4.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.4.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. The medicine cup is intended for serving various types of medication to hospital patients.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Selection of applicable level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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